

Starting a new restaurant is such an exciting venture! Green Street is a vibrant, high-traffic location, especially with its proximity to the University of Illinois campus—it's a fantastic spot for a new concept.

Because regulations for food service establishments are highly specific to the building, your menu, and your equipment, there isn't one "universal" cost or law. However, I can point you exactly where you need to go to get those definitive numbers for your business plan.

1. Zoning Regulations

To find the exact zoning for a specific address on Green Street, you should use the [Champaign County GIS Consortium \(CGISC\) interactive webmap](#).

- **What to do:** Search by the street address or PIN. It will show you the zoning district (e.g., CB, B-3, etc.).
- **Next step:** Once you know the district, check the City of Champaign's [Zoning Ordinance](#). For any major changes or new construction, I strongly recommend a pre-application conference with the City's Planning and Development Department (217-403-8800). They can tell you immediately if your restaurant concept is a "permitted use" or if you'll need a "special use permit."

2. Health Department Permit Costs

Permit fees are managed by the [Champaign-Urbana Public Health District \(C-UPHD\)](#).

- **The Process:** Before you can get a permit, you must go through a **Plan Review**. This verifies that your kitchen design, equipment, and water systems meet state food codes.
- **Costs:** Fees are generally categorized by the size and complexity of your food service (Category I, II, or III). You should check their most recent fee schedule on the C-UPHD website to see which category your specific menu and square footage fall under.

3. Commercial Rent Expectations

Green Street is a prime location, and rents reflect that demand. Based on current market listings, you'll find significant variability:

- **Average Range:** You can expect to see rates ranging from **\$11 to \$36 per square foot per year**, depending on whether the space is a raw shell, a "second-generation" restaurant (which might already have some kitchen infrastructure), or a high-visibility storefront.
- **Tip:** Always clarify if the lease is **Triple Net (NNN)**, where you pay for property taxes, insurance, and maintenance on top of base rent, or if it includes some utilities.

4. Grease Trap Installation

Grease traps are non-negotiable for commercial kitchens to prevent sewer line clogs.

- **Requirement:** The specific size (gallons) is usually mandated by the **Illinois Plumbing Code** based on your kitchen's fixture flow-through rate.
- **Professional Consultation:** Do not purchase equipment until you have consulted with a **licensed Illinois plumbing contractor**. They will calculate the required volume and help ensure your installation meets both state codes and any additional requirements from the local sanitary district.

Would you like me to help you draft a "discovery checklist" of questions to ask a commercial real estate broker or a local architect? Having that list ready can save you a lot of time!